

Republic Disguised as Democracy

The Oligarchic Structure of Parliamentarism

From electoral permission to citizen sovereignty



The Core Deception

- Elections without rule
- Representation without mandate
- Public interest defined from above
- Citizens as spectators
- Oligarchy with democratic branding

1 vote

Political equality is necessary, not sufficient

Democratic appearance

elections · parties · parliament

≠

Oligarchic command

agenda · law · enforcement

Argument 1 · Elections Are Not Rule

- Res publica
- Managed public interest
- Officeholder interpretation
- No citizen agenda-setting
- No continuous sovereignty



Aristotle · Rousseau · Dahl

Argument 2 · Parliamentarism Inverts Power

- Parties select candidates
- Voters ratify options
- Representatives obey party line
- Government dominates parliament
- Citizens lose command

Citizens

formal source



Parties

candidate filter



Parliament

party discipline

Policy descends after citizens ratify options

Argument 3 · Oligarchy Reproduces Itself

- Party machines
- Economic oligarchy
- Media influence
- State appointments
- Weak accountability

50/100

Corruption perception score · Greece

Access becomes power

- party entry
- media visibility
- state appointments

Accountability Breakdown

86/180

Press freedom rank · Greece

55.05

Press freedom score

- Institutional pressure
- Wiretapping concerns
- SLAPP pressure
- Information control
- Accountability deficit

Satisfaction · Constitutional Makeover

- Citizen-initiated referenda
- Citizen legislative power
- Recall of officials
- Independent justice
- Transparent public finance
- Anti-corruption prosecution

Citizen Body

must become a constitutional institution

referendum · initiative · recall · audit · justice

Visualization · Two Political Orders

Republic as Oligarchy

- Voting ritual
- Party command
- Elite bargaining
- Opaque decisions
- Managed citizens

power sits above citizens

Constitutional Democracy

- Citizen rule
- Direct mandate
- Recall
- Public audit
- Accountable institutions

power returns to citizens

Action · Demand Citizen Sovereignty

- Reject electoral minimalism
- Demand constitutional reform
- Support citizen referenda
- Support recall powers
- Organize beyond parties



Citizens must become an institution.

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